

TRAVIS HOKI

Senior Software Engineer

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Design Engineer | GC AI

Dear Hiring Manager,

I bridge design and engineering in a way most frontend engineers cannot. I started college with a Gaming & Animation emphasis before switching to Web Development, and I still illustrate on my own time. That combination, someone who thinks visually and ships production code, is exactly what a Design Engineer role is asking for, and it is rare to find in one person.

Why I think GC AI is awesome!

Making sophisticated legal work feel simple is a real design problem, not just a UI polish problem. A detail like Exact Quote, tying every AI statement to a verifiable citation, is a genuinely hard interface challenge. It means showing a source inline without breaking the reading flow, and making trust feel built in rather than an extra step. I also want to be working at the edge of what AI can actually do right now, not just wrapping a UI around it after the fact. A feature like that is exactly where interface design and model behavior meet.

Why you should think I am awesome!

I have 14 years of expert-level React, TypeScript, HTML, and CSS, and real accessibility experience. I brought Overstock's User Generated Content templates into ADA compliance. I have worked extensively with Storybook and component-driven design systems, and I bring systems-building experience beyond that too. I architected internationalization infrastructure from scratch at Spiff, and I wrote the tooling, dead-code detection, lint enforcement, that became a team-wide standard. I also bring real B2B SaaS experience, Spiff and XANT, and I have designed and built marketing sites end to end, including the brand and storefront for a company I founded myself. I mentor through pairing, and I authored the frontend architectural standards adopted across the whole engineering org at XANT.

Why we would be awesome together!

I like ambiguity and ownership more than I like structure for its own sake. Joining Spiff as an early engineer and building platform infrastructure from scratch, through to acquisition, is exactly that kind of work. One honest note: my animation experience comes from building a physics-driven mobile game and from formal animation coursework, not from shipping interface micro-interactions specifically. The instincts transfer, motion with purpose, timing, easing, but I want to be upfront that it is adjacent experience, not a direct match.

Sincerely,
Travis Hoki

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 14+ years of experience building, scaling, and modernizing web applications. I bridge design and engineering in a way most frontend specialists cannot: I started college with a Gaming & Animation emphasis before switching to Web Development, I still illustrate on my own time, and I have worked directly with designers in Figma. My React and TypeScript expertise is backed by ADA-accessible interface work at Overstock and systems-building experience, internationalization infrastructure and technical-debt tooling I built from scratch at Spiff. I also bring real B2B SaaS experience (Spiff, XANT) and marketing site design and development (Hoki Skateboards, Enspark). Joined Spiff as an early frontend engineer and stayed through its acquisition by Salesforce.

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **AI-Assisted Development:** Claude Code, Cursor AI, AI-assisted production development
- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Sass/SCSS, Less, PHP, Python, SQL, Ruby
- **Frontend:** React, React Native, Redux, AngularJS, jQuery, Handlebars, Lexical, Storybook, Server-Side Rendering (SSR), Responsive UI, Internationalization (i18n/l10n), Accessibility
- **Backend & Data:** Node.js, Express, Django, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Firebase/Firestore, GraphQL, REST APIs and API integration, Stripe
- **Testing & Code Quality:** Jest, Vitest, React Testing Library, Cypress, TDD, ESLint (custom rule sets), Prettier, Stylelint, Husky pre-commit hooks, coverage enforcement
- **Build & Platform:** Webpack, Vite, Git/GitHub, CI automation, AWS S3, WordPress/WooCommerce

WORK HISTORY

Senior Member of the Technical Staff – **Salesforce** (Mar. 2024 – May 2026)

Stayed on for two years after Salesforce acquired Spiff in March 2024, scaling the product for enterprise accounts.

- Raised the frontend codebase to Salesforce's post-acquisition quality standards, expanding Jest coverage and establishing strict ESLint rule sets. That work drove company-wide TypeScript adoption.
- Adopted Claude Code and Cursor AI into daily development, pair programming with them on refactors, debugging, and test-coverage work.
- Shipped a document composer on the Lexical editor framework after evaluating several WYSIWYG options, customizing it heavily for document workflows. Added a Handlebars-style merge-field system that resolves placeholders to live profile values at render time. Extended the server-side Ruby layer to customize PDF output.

Frontend Engineer – **Spiff**, acquired by Salesforce (Aug. 2021 – Mar. 2024)

Built core platform infrastructure at the startup, through to acquisition.

- Architected the frontend internationalization infrastructure from the ground up and migrated thousands of hardcoded strings across the application. Launched the product in Japanese, Spanish, and additional locales, supporting a major expansion priority for Spiff and Salesforce.
- Created a pseudo-localization tool that became the team's standard pre-merge check for untranslated UI. It renders every translated string as X's, letting any engineer spot gaps in seconds.
- Wrote custom automated tooling scripts (dead-code detection, unused-export pruning, lint enforcement) that systematically drove down technical debt across the repository.
- Designed a recursive component tree that renders company org hierarchies at any depth, powering team-based commission structures for enterprise accounts.
- Developed features against GraphQL APIs and practiced TDD, writing Jest and React Testing Library specs before implementation.

Senior Software Engineer – **XANT**, formerly *InsideSales.com* (Dec. 2020 – Aug. 2021)

- Authored the frontend architectural standards adopted across the engineering organization, defining code conventions, lint rules, and component structure.
- Mentored mid-level and junior developers through pair programming, working alongside them on their own projects to unblock delivery and grow their skills.
- Modernized legacy frontend architecture and JavaScript patterns, improving runtime performance and reducing ongoing maintenance burden.

Web Developer – **Chatbooks** (Mar. 2019 – Aug. 2020)

- Rebuilt the book creation flow, one of the company's core revenue paths, in React. Unlocked Premium Layflat book creation on desktop, giving customers a far better large-format editing experience.

- Executed a progressive, zero-downtime migration from legacy AngularJS to React across the customer-facing site, preserving production stability throughout.
- Built Cards taxonomy pages with category browsing and search filters using Node.js server-side rendering, accelerating page loads and improving SEO discoverability.
- Implemented Branch deep links and platform-specific quick-flow screens routing customers from Instagram's storefront into the iOS and Android apps.

Front-End Developer – Overstock.com, now Bed Bath & Beyond (Sept. 2015 – Mar. 2019)

- Owned the frontend for all User Generated Content on a high-traffic national e-commerce site: ratings, reviews, customer photos, and Q&A. Brought these templates into ADA accessibility compliance.
- Launched customer review images end to end, validating and formatting uploads client-side before pushing to AWS S3. Real customer photos let shoppers see products in use before buying.
- Led the site-wide migration of star ratings behind feature flags, coordinating simultaneous multi-department deploys. Introduced rating-only reviews, measurably increasing review volume.
- Rebuilt the responsive See All Reviews page and embedded a reusable React Add To Cart module into the mobile review flow. A two-week A/B test showed conversion lift.
- Delivered an internal SEO admin portal (React, Redux, Node.js, Express) letting business users manage SEO titles and taxonomy display names.
- Ported featured-product logic into an AMP search page using amp-bind, optimizing CSS to meet strict AMP size limits. Rearchitected a WordPress plugin into the embeddable affiliate-links widget that launched the affiliate program.

Full Stack Developer – Room Choice (Dec. 2014 – Aug. 2015)

- Developed full-stack features for student-housing management software using AngularJS/CoffeeScript on the frontend and Python/Django with PostgreSQL on the backend.
- Optimized queries, reporting, and application performance as the platform scaled to a rapidly growing number of students and institutional accounts.
- Designed and integrated the RESTful APIs between frontend and backend layers, collaborating with an international, distributed engineering team.

Custom Developer – Enspark (Nov. 2011 – Dec. 2014)

- Rebuilt the company's Learning Management System in PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, and jQuery, implementing user-account progress tracking across the eLearning catalog.
- Built custom web applications and features for small-business clients, spanning design, frontend, backend, and WordPress theme development.
- Produced interactive eLearning courses and marketing banners in Adobe Flash using ActionScript 3.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Hoki Skateboards Website – PHP, WordPress, WooCommerce, JavaScript, Stripe | hokiskateboards.com

Founded a skateboard company selling skateboards, apparel, and a self-published children's book. Designed the brand and built the storefront on a custom WordPress theme, with WooCommerce and Stripe handling retail and checkout.

Food Cards – React, TypeScript, Firebase, Anthropic Claude API | food-cards.travishoki.com

A safe-foods catalog built for my son, who has food avoidance issues. Integrated Claude via the Anthropic SDK (@anthropic-ai/sdk) so users filter the collection in plain English. "Easy breakfast ideas" resolves to category, difficulty, sort order, and keyword filters at once. Prompt engineering enforces schema-validated JSON, so ambiguous output degrades gracefully rather than breaking the UI. Also implemented scored fuzzy search.

Hoki Skateboards App – React Native, TypeScript, React Native Game Engine, Matter.js, Firebase | hokiskateboards.com/app

Designed, illustrated, and built a mobile game in React Native, shipping one codebase to iOS and Android as real native UI. Published on the [Apple App Store](https://apps.apple.com) and Google Play.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Digital Media (Emphasis in Internet Technology) – Utah Valley University

Associate in Applied Science, Digital Communication Technology – Utah Valley University

BEYOND ENGINEERING

Illustrator and self-published author of two children's books, one Kickstarter-funded. Improv Broadway stand-up comedy graduate and volunteer Cub Scouts den leader.

PORTFOLIO

TravisHoki.com – React, TypeScript, Vite, Storybook, Jest/Vitest | travishoki.com

Check out my portfolio to see this work in detail: case studies, screenshots, and write-ups for the projects above plus 20+ more from across my career.